

Vanina Pappacena |

Head of UX Practice / DesignOps & Strategy Leader

Specialist in scaling UX teams, systems and decision-making

vani.pappacena@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | <https://vaninapappacena.com/> |

📍 Open to Remote/Contract B2B

Professional Summary

Organizational Design Strategist & Change Facilitator with 8+ years of experience transforming how teams collaborate in complex environments. I specialize in **driving cultural change and operational efficiency** by integrating Agile methodologies with scalable Design Systems.

Previously, I led a team of 20 at the Government of Buenos Aires, where I orchestrated the cultural and technical adoption of the 'Obelisco' Design System across the city's digital infrastructure. As a consultant, **I facilitate strategic reflection spaces (Discovery, Founders' Alignment, Process Definition) to help organizations optimize workflows and adopt ethical, user-centered mindsets.**

Work Experience

STRATEGIC DESIGN & INNOVATION CONSULTANT

Independent Consultant (Clients: Bleett, Calicó, I+DIoT Lab) | Remote | Dec 2021 – Present

- **Strategic Alignment & Founder Coaching:** Facilitated reflection spaces and discovery workshops for founders and C-level leaders to clarify product vision, align business goals, and define strategic roadmaps.
- **Organizational Design & Workflow Strategy:** Led "Process Discovery" sessions where teams analyzed their own bottlenecks, resulting in the co-creation of optimized workflows for Product Management and HR/People teams.
- **Cultural Transformation & Methodologies:** Designed and moderated spaces for team reflection (Retrospectives, Feedback Loops) to foster a culture of continuous improvement and embed Agile/User-Centered rituals into daily operations.

OPERATIONAL MANAGER OF UX & DESIGN SYSTEMS LEAD

Government of the City of Buenos Aires | Buenos Aires, Argentina | 2020 – 2023

Previously: Submanager of Accessibility & Usability (2020–2021)

- **Architected and scaled "Obelisco", the city's first centralized Design System**, standardizing UX/UI across 50+ digital touchpoints and serving **3 million+ active citizens** with consistent, accessible digital services.
- **Led Cultural Adoption & Governance**: Orchestrated the shift from fragmented silos to a unified digital ecosystem. This reduced development cycles by **~40%** not just through code, but by aligning the working culture of **20+ cross-functional teams**.
- **Team Leadership & Capacity Building**: Managed a team of 20 designers/devs, establishing new operational standards and driving the adoption of scalable component libraries as the "single source of truth."
- **Accessibility Compliance Leadership**: Directed the implementation of WCAG standards across critical citizen services, ensuring inclusivity was a core KPI for government digital products

Key skills & expertise

- **Organizational Transformation**: Change Management, Cultural Adoption Strategies, DesignOps, Process Optimization.
- **Facilitation & Leadership: Strategic Facilitation (Discovery/Reflection Spaces)**, Founders' Alignment, Team Mentoring (20+ people), Stakeholder Management.
- **Design Strategy**: Systemic Design, Ethical Frameworks, Design Systems Architecture, Service Design.
- **Ethics & Data Principles**: Responsible Innovation, Ethical Technology Frameworks, Accessibility (WCAG 2.2 Standards) & Usability Principles.

Education

Master's Degree in Interactive Design | University of Buenos Aires (UBA-FADU) 2018 – 2020

Thesis: **Design in Dialogue with Ethics – 2024**

Bachelor's Degree in Graphic Design | University of Buenos Aires (UBA-FADU) 2008 – 2016

Diploma in Web Usability and Accessibility | National Technological University (UTN) 2017

Professional Update

- **OKRS Design Certified** | Agile Quest
- **Management 3.0** | Agile Spin
- **Digital Ethnography as a Social Research Method** | UTN

Languages

Spanish (native).

English: Professional Working Proficiency (B2+)